The Missed Appointment

Visit record

Manchester Metropolitan University

Student: Alex
Date: 11 November 2026
Route: You looked around the flat and agreed a plan with Graham.
Rapport: Graham opened up to you.

SBAR handover to Sam

Situation

Home visit to Graham Knowles, 74, who has COPD. He has missed his last two reviews and his blue reliever inhaler is nearly empty.

Background

Lives alone in a council flat, widowed, daughter in Leeds. Repeat prescription not collected for six weeks. Smokes about 10 a day.

Assessment

Breathless walking to the Market Hall. Thermostat at 12°C to save money, mould behind the bed, almost no food in the fridge. No preventer inhaler seen.

Recommendation

COPD review at home with the community team, arrange prescription delivery, refer for stop-smoking support and advice on heating costs and benefits. I'll ring him tomorrow.

Priorities chosen before the visit

- How he's using his inhalers, and whether he has any left
  Why: His prescription hasn't been collected for six weeks, so he may have run out.
- How breathless he is, at rest and moving about
  Why: How breathless he is tells us how unwell he is today.
- Whether the flat is warm, dry and safe
  Why: A cold, damp flat would make his COPD worse.

Notes on the voicemail

Pat hasn't seen Graham out all week. He looked grey and breathless, and she doesn't think the heating is on.

What you noticed in the flat (7 of 7)

- Inhaler on the coffee table: Health risk
- Ashtray and cigarettes: Health risk
- Thermostat: Both
- Rug edge: Health risk
- Phone on the side table: Both

- Fridge: Both
- Wall behind the bed: Health risk

Plan agreed with Graham

- Offer his COPD review at home, with the community team
- Arrange for his prescription to be collected or delivered
- Offer support to stop smoking
- Refer him for advice on heating costs and benefits

Feedback from Sam

- You got the visit Graham needed. He let you look round and talked about what's really going on: the walk, the prescription, the cold and the cigarettes.
- You noticed 7 of 7 things in the flat.
- A home review and sorting out the prescription tackle the two main reasons he's missed care.
- Your plan involves the Chemist, the stop-smoking service and welfare and energy advice. Make sure your SBAR says who you'll contact.
- Checking the plan back with Graham gave him a say in it.

Your reflections

How did Graham respond to the way you spoke and where you positioned yourself? What did you notice?

Sitting at his eye level and not rushing helped him relax, and he started telling me about the walk and the money.

What assumptions did you have about Graham before the visit? Did any of them change?

I assumed he was just avoiding the clinic. The real barriers were getting there, the cost of heating and running out of medicine.

Evidence for learning outcomes

- LO1: Identify social, environmental and economic factors: evidence
- LO2: Communicate in a person-centred way: evidence
- LO3: Agree next steps and involve the team: evidence
- LO4: Reflect on assumptions and decisions: evidence
- LO5: Recognise environmental risks at home: evidence

What to do with this record

Upload it to your placement portfolio or send it to your practice educator.